FREE LEAD MAGNET — TMS LIST

The TMS Patient Acquisition Playbook

A proven, multi-channel framework for attracting, converting, and retaining TMS patients in a competitive mental health market.

BY TMS LIST · TMSLIST.COM · 2026 EDITION

TMSList

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1. The 5-Channel Patient Acquisition Framework

Every growing TMS practice relies on a diversified patient acquisition strategy. Relying on a single channel is risky — algorithm changes, referral fatigue, and market shifts can erode your pipeline overnight. The framework below distributes your effort across five complementary channels, each with distinct strengths, costs, and timelines. Use this as a strategic map, then dive into the channel-specific playbooks in subsequent sections.

Channel Overview

#	CHANNEL	ESTIMATED LEAD VOLUME	COST PER LEAD (CPL)	TIMELINE TO RESULTS	BEST FOR
1	**Physician Referrals**	5–25 consults/month	$0–$80	3–6 months	High-intent, insurance-verified patients
2	**Paid Search (Google Ads)**	30–150 clicks/day	$40–$120	2–4 weeks	Immediate lead flow, keyword targeting
3	**Organic SEO & Content**	10–60 organic visits/day	$5–$25 (content cost)	6–12 months	Long-term compounding traffic, authority
4	**Patient Reviews & Reputation**	Indirect — amplifies all channels	$0–$20/review	1–3 months	Trust signals, conversion rate lift
5	**Direct-to-Consumer (DTC) Campaigns**	Varies by spend	$60–$200	2–8 weeks	Brand awareness, patient self-referrals

STRATEGIC NOTE

Start with 2–3 channels simultaneously for the first 90 days. Physician referrals are the highest-quality leads but take time to build. Pair them with Google Ads for immediate volume while your referral network matures. Organic SEO is a long-term investment — begin content production now even if results are months away.

Channel 1 — Physician Referrals

Psychiatrists, primary care physicians (PCPs), therapists, and nurse practitioners are your highest-quality referral sources. A referred patient has a 3–5x higher consultation-to-treatment conversion rate compared to a cold ad click. The physician referral blueprint is covered in Section 3.

Channel 2 — Paid Search (Google Ads)

Google Ads provides the fastest path to patient leads. With proper keyword selection, ad copy, and landing page optimization, you can be generating qualified leads within two weeks of launching a campaign. The full Google Ads setup is in Section 2.

Channel 3 — Organic SEO & Content Marketing

Long-form blog articles, patient FAQs, provider guides, and TMS explainer content all serve to capture patients searching for answers online. Content published today continues to generate traffic for years — making this the highest-return investment over a 24-month horizon.

Channel 4 — Patient Reviews & Reputation

Online reviews on Google, Yelp, and Healthgrades are trust signals that influence every other channel. A practice with 50+ reviews averaging 4.8 stars converts 30–40% better than a comparable practice with fewer reviews. Section 5 covers systematic testimonial collection.

Channel 5 — Direct-to-Consumer (DTC) Campaigns

Social media advertising, community outreach, employer wellness partnerships, and patient education webinars all fall under DTC. These campaigns bypass physician gatekeepers and reach patients directly who may be suffering in silence.

> *"Within 90 days of implementing the 5-channel framework, we went from 8 TMS consultations per month to 31. The combination of Google Ads for volume and physician referrals for quality completely changed our practice economics."*
>
> **Dr. Sarah K., TMS Clinic Director**
> Mid-size psychiatry practice, Chicago suburbs

2. Google Ads Campaign Setup

Google Ads is your most controllable, scalable, and measurable patient acquisition channel. This section gives you the complete keyword list, three ad copy variants, landing page requirements, budget recommendations, and bidding strategy guidance to launch a high-performing campaign from day one.

Keyword List (50+ TMS-Specific Keywords)

Organize your campaigns into themed ad groups. Use exact and phrase match types for high-performing keywords; use broad match to discover new queries once campaigns are profitable.

- transcranial magnetic stimulation
- TMS therapy
- TMS treatment
- TMS for depression
- TMS for anxiety
- TMS therapy near me
- TMS treatment near me
- TMS clinic near me
- non-invasive brain stimulation
- brain stimulation therapy
- neurostimulation treatment
- medication resistant depression treatment
- treatment resistant depression TMS
- TMS insurance coverage
- does insurance cover TMS
- TMS therapy cost
- TMS treatment cost
- deep TMS
- Accelerated TMS
- SAINT TMS protocol
- TMS therapy success rate
- TMS side effects
- is TMS therapy safe
- TMS procedure
- how does TMS work
- alternatives to ECT
- TMS vs ECT
- depression treatment without medication
- drug free depression treatment
- mental health clinic
- psychiatry clinic TMS
- outpatient TMS
- in-home TMS
- TMS for OCD
- TMS for PTSD
- TMS for bipolar depression
- repetitive transcranial magnetic stimulation
- rTMS treatment
- intermittent theta burst stimulation
- iTBS TMS
- high frequency TMS
- left dorsolateral prefrontal cortex TMS
- depression treatment center
- anxiety treatment center
- TMS provider
- find TMS therapy
- best TMS clinic
- FDA approved TMS
- cleared TMS device
- chronic depression treatment
- severe depression treatment options
- mental health treatment options
- TMS consultation
- free TMS consultation
- TMS evaluation

Negative Keyword List

Add these as negatives to prevent wasted spend on non-patient queries:

- magnetic stimulation machine
- TMS truck
- transcranial magnetic stimulation certification
- TMS magnet
- transcranial magnetic stimulation research
- buy TMS machine
- TMS coil
- magnetic brain stimulation at home DIY

Ad Copy Templates

Write three variants for each ad group: Awareness (patient is just learning about TMS), Consideration (patient is comparing options), and Comparison (patient is evaluating TMS against other treatments).

VARIANT A — AWARENESS

HEADLINE 1 (MAX 30)
FDA-Cleared TMS Therapy

HEADLINE 2 (MAX 30)
Non-Invasive, Drug-Free Depression Relief

HEADLINE 3 (MAX 30)
Insurance Often Covers TMS

DESCRIPTION (MAX 90)
Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation targets the root of treatment-resistant depression and anxiety without medication or surgery. Find out if TMS is right for you. Book a free consultation today.

VARIANT B — CONSIDERATION

HEADLINE 1 (MAX 30)
TMS Therapy for Treatment-Resistant Cases

HEADLINE 2 (MAX 30)
Proven for Depression & Anxiety

HEADLINE 3 (MAX 30)
36 Sessions in 6–8 Weeks

DESCRIPTION (MAX 90)
If medication hasn't worked, TMS may be the answer. Non-invasive brain stimulation with a 50–60% response rate in clinical studies. Most insurance plans accepted. Schedule your evaluation now.

VARIANT C — COMPARISON

HEADLINE 1 (MAX 30)
TMS vs. Medication — Which Wins?

HEADLINE 2 (MAX 30)
No Pills. No Surgery. Real Results.

HEADLINE 3 (MAX 30)
Free Insurance Check & Consult

DESCRIPTION (MAX 90)
TMS therapy offers a drug-free alternative for depression and anxiety when medications stop working. Compare your options at our free patient education seminar or schedule a one-on-one consult today.

Landing Page Requirements

Your Google Ads must point to a dedicated landing page — not your homepage. The landing page must include:

- **Hero headline** matching the ad copy headline within 3 words
- **Sub-headline** addressing the patient's primary pain point (e.g., "When medication isn't enough")
- **CTA button** above the fold: "Schedule Free Consultation" or "Check My Insurance"
- **Insurance logos** or "Most Major Insurance Accepted" badge
- **Social proof**: star rating, review count, or patient photo
- **FAQ section** addressing top objections (cost, safety, time commitment)
- **Phone number** and click-to-call link in the header
- **Trust signals**: FDA clearance mention, provider credentials, clinic photos
- **Form**: Name, phone, email, and one qualifying question (e.g., "Have you tried medication for your depression?")

LANDING PAGE TIP

Pages that load in under 3 seconds convert 32% better than slower pages. Compress images, use a CDN, and eliminate unnecessary scripts. A dedicated landing page should have zero navigation links to other pages — every path leads to the consultation booking.

Budget Recommendations

PRACTICE STAGE	MONTHLY BUDGET	RECOMMENDED CAMPAIGNS	TARGET CPL
Launch (Month 1–2)	$1,500–$3,000	Search (1 campaign, 3 ad groups)	$80–$120
Scale (Month 3–6)	$3,000–$7,500	Search + Display Remarketing	$55–$90
Optimize (Month 6+)	$7,500–$15,000	Search + Display + YouTube + Local	$40–$70

Bidding Strategy

- **Initial 30 days:** Manual CPC bidding — gives you control while you learn which keywords convert
- **Days 31–60:** Switch to Target CPA (cost per acquisition) bidding, using your historical conversion data
- **Month 3+:** Target ROAS (return on ad spend) at 3x or higher — meaning every dollar spent returns $3
- **Audience signals:** Upload your existing patient email list as a Customer Match audience to target similar users
- **Location targeting:** 15–25 mile radius around your clinic. Add surrounding zip codes where drive time is under 45 minutes
- **Schedule optimization:** Run ads 7 days/week, but analyze which days/times generate consultations vs. just clicks. Pause low-performing time slots after 4 weeks of data

> *"Our Google Ads CPL dropped from $145 to $68 over six months by following this framework — specifically by tightening keyword match types, writing ad copy that matched landing page headlines, and switching to Target CPA at the right moment."*
>
> **Practice Manager, Coastal TMS Center**
> Southeast US, 4-provider practice

3. Physician Referral Network Blueprint

Physician referrals are the gold standard of patient acquisition: high intent, insurance-verified, and often pre-educated about TMS. This section shows you exactly how to identify, reach, and cultivate a referral network that generates a steady stream of qualified patients month after month.

Identifying Top Referral Sources

SPECIALTY	PATIENT OVERLAP WITH TMS	REFERRAL VOLUME POTENTIAL	OUTREACH PRIORITY
Psychiatrists	Highest — manage treatment-resistant depression, anxiety disorders, OCD	High (10–30/month per active referrer)	Priority 1 — start here
Primary Care Physicians (PCP)	High — first-line depression diagnosis, medication management	Medium–High (5–15/month per referrer)	Priority 1 — PCP panel is largest
Therapists / LCSWs / Psychologists	High — manage patients on medication who want adjunctive care	Medium (3–10/month per referrer)	Priority 2 — high volume, indirect referral
Internal Medicine	Medium — comorbid depression in chronic illness patients	Medium (3–8/month per referrer)	Priority 2
OB/GYN	Medium — postpartum depression, perimenopausal mood changes	Low–Medium (2–5/month per referrer)	Priority 3 — niche, high empathy match
Student Health Centers	Medium — young adults with depression/anxiety	Medium (5–15/month during academic year)	Priority 3 — if near university/college

Outreach Templates

EMAIL TEMPLATE — COLD OUTREACH

Subject: Collaborative care option for your treatment-resistant depression patients

Dear Dr. [Last Name],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I am [Title] at [Clinic Name], a TMS therapy center serving [City/Region].

I'm reaching out because I know that many of your patients struggle with depression that hasn't responded fully to medication — a challenge I hear about often from referring physicians in our community.

TMS (Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation) is an FDA-cleared, non-invasive treatment that works alongside existing care. We've helped [X] patients in [City] find meaningful relief, and I'd love to explore how we might collaborate to support your patients who need additional options.

I'd welcome 15 minutes of your time — in person, by phone, or over a video call — to share more about our approach and how we coordinate care with referring providers. Would any of the following dates work for you?

[Date A], [Date B], or [Date C]

Warm regards,

[Your Name]
[Title] | [Clinic Name]
[Phone] | [Email]
[Website]

LETTER TEMPLATE — FORMAL REFERRAL REQUEST

[Your Name]
[Title]
[Clinic Name]
[Address]

[Date]

Dr. [Last Name]
[Practice Name]
[Address]

Re: Collaborative Care Partnership for TMS Therapy

Dear Dr. [Last Name],

I am writing to introduce [Clinic Name] as a resource for your patients with treatment-resistant depression and anxiety. [Clinic Name] specializes in Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS) — an FDA-cleared, non-invasive neuromodulation therapy that has helped hundreds of patients in [City/Region] achieve significant symptom reduction.

We take a collaborative approach to care. For every patient we see, we provide:

- A comprehensive intake evaluation and clinical report sent to the referring physician
- Regular progress updates during the treatment course
- A detailed discharge summary with recommendations for ongoing care
- Direct phone access to our clinical team for any questions

Enclosed is our referral form and clinical overview. To refer a patient, please have them call [Phone] or complete the online referral form at [URL]. We handle insurance verification and prior authorizations at no charge to your practice or your patient.

I would welcome the opportunity to meet with you — in person or virtually — to discuss how we might work together. Please don't hesitate to reach out directly.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]
[Title] | [Clinic Name]

Follow-Up Cadence

1. **Day 0 — Initial Outreach**
   Send email + physical letter simultaneously. Mail the letter to the practice address, email to the provider's known inbox.

2. **Day 7 — First Follow-Up Call**
   Call the practice front desk. Ask for Dr. [Name]'s office manager or clinical assistant. Briefly introduce yourself and confirm receipt of the letter. Request a 10-minute call with the physician.

3. **Day 14 — Second Email**
   Send a value-add email: share a relevant clinical study, a patient success story (de-identified), or an upcoming TMS education event. Keep it brief and provider-focused.

4. **Day 30 — Lunch-and-Learn Invitation**
   Formally invite the physician to a lunch-and-learn at their office or a nearby restaurant. Offer to bring food. Present a 20-minute TMS overview with clinical data. See Section 3 of the companion playbook for full Lunch-and-Learn details.

5. **Day 60 — Quarterly Touch**
   Send a brief quarterly update: number of referrals received, patient outcomes, any new TMS protocols or insurance updates. Personalize — this is a relationship, not a blast.

6. **Day 90 — Re-Engagement**
   If no referrals after 90 days, send a re-engagement message highlighting a new TMS protocol, a new clinical publication, or a patient outcome from a similar case type.

Referral Tracking Spreadsheet Layout

PROVIDER NAME	SPECIALTY	PRACTICE	CONTACT	INITIAL OUTREACH DATE	LAST CONTACT	REFERRALS SENT	REFERRALS CONVERTED	NOTES	NEXT ACTION	FOLLOW-UP DATE
Dr. Jane Smith	Psychiatry	Bay Area Psychiatry	jsmith@bayareapsych.com	2026-01-15	2026-03-10	4	2	Interested in iTBS protocols	Send iTBS clinical summary	2026-04-10
Dr. Mark Lee	PCP	Family Medicine Group	mlee@familymedgroup.com	2026-02-01	2026-02-08	1	0	Left voicemail; no response to email	Send letter + call front desk	2026-04-15
Dr. Priya Patel	Therapy/LCSW	Mindful Counseling	ppatel@mindfulcounseling.com	2026-01-20	2026-03-20	7	5	Top referrer; sends patients monthly	Send thank-you gift + quarterly report	2026-04-20

4. 30-Day Social Media Content Calendar

Consistency is the currency of social media. This calendar provides a week-by-week roadmap for Instagram, Facebook, and LinkedIn, with specific post types, content topics, and calls-to-action. The goal is to build awareness, establish clinical authority, nurture leads, and drive consultation bookings — in that order.

POSTING FREQUENCY RECOMMENDATION

Instagram: 4–5 posts/week + 1 story/day. Facebook: 3–4 posts/week. LinkedIn: 2–3 posts/week. Reels and short-form video consistently outperform static posts in reach and engagement — aim for 2–3 video posts per week across platforms.

30-Day Calendar

WEEK	PLATFORM	POST TYPE	CONTENT TOPIC	CTA
Week 1 Days 1–7	Instagram Reel	Educational Reel (60–90s)	"What is TMS? A 60-second explainer" — cover the basics: what it is, how it works, FDA clearance	Save this post for later
	Facebook	Patient Story (static image + caption)	De-identified patient success story: "After 3 medications failed, Sarah found relief with TMS" — focus on journey and outcome, not clinical details	Comment "MORE" for our free TMS guide
	LinkedIn	Clinical Article Share	Share a peer-reviewed TMS study with a 3-sentence commentary from the provider: "This new study confirms what we've seen in our practice..."	Read the full study + share your thoughts
	Instagram Story	Poll / Quiz	"True or False: TMS is painful" — address the #1 patient fear and demystify the treatment experience	DM us with questions
	Facebook	Behind the Scenes	Photo tour of the TMS clinic: waiting area, treatment room, TMS device. Humanize the experience: "What to expect on your first visit"	Send us a DM to schedule a tour
Week 2 Days 8–14	Instagram Reel	Provider Q&A (60s)	Provider answers: "What's the biggest misconception about TMS?" — address ECT confusion, needle fears, cost concerns	Follow for weekly Q&A
	LinkedIn	Professional Post	"5 signs your patient may benefit from TMS referral" — clinical criteria targeting referring physicians and therapists	DM us to discuss a referral partnership
	Facebook	Educational Carousel	"TMS vs. Medication: A side-by-side comparison" — slides covering mechanism, timeline, side effects, cost, success rates	Download our free comparison guide
	Instagram	Infographic Post	Visual: "Who is a candidate for TMS?" — bullet criteria, depression severity scales, medication history requirements	Check if you qualify — link in bio
	Instagram Story	Testimonial Re-share	Short video testimonial clip (15s) with provider's response: "We love hearing from our patients"	Share your TMS story with us
Week 3 Days 15–21	Instagram Reel	Treatment Day Vlog	"A day in the life of a TMS patient — from consult to session 1" — walk through the actual patient experience	Book your consultation
	Facebook	Insurance Education Post	"Does insurance cover TMS?" — explain Medicare, BCBS, Aetna, United coverage patterns, prior auth process	Free insurance check — DM us
	LinkedIn	Case Study (anonymized)	"Case Study: 52-year-old male with treatment-resistant depression achieved remission after TMS protocol" — clinical narrative for professional audience	Connect with our clinical team
	Instagram	Carousel	"TMS myths vs. facts" — 5 slides debunking: "TMS is experimental," "It causes seizures," "It hurts," etc.	Share with someone who needs this info
	Facebook Live	Live Q&A (30 min)	Provider-hosted live: "Ask the TMS Expert — Depression, TMS, and Your Options" — address live audience questions	RSVP in comments
Week 4 Days 22–30	Instagram Reel	Results/Outcome Post	"6 weeks ago she started TMS. Here's her progress." — progress-tracking narrative (with patient written consent)	Start your TMS journey today
	LinkedIn	Industry News	"CMS expands TMS coverage for 2026 — what it means for your practice and patients" — policy update with clinical implications	Learn more on our blog
	Facebook	Referral Partner Spotlight	"Meet Dr. [Name], one of our top referring physicians" — brief interview, why they refer, their experience with our clinic	Join our referral network
	Instagram	Engagement Post	"Tag someone who deserves to feel better" — community-building, reach amplification	Share this post
	Instagram + Facebook	Consultation CTA Push	"Limited consultation availability this month — book now to secure your spot" — scarcity/urgency post (use sparingly, 1x/month max)	Book your free consultation

CONTENT PRODUCTION TIPS

Batch-create content in 2-hour sessions once per week — don't create daily. Use a tool like Later, Hootsuite, or Meta Business Suite to schedule posts. Film provider Q&A videos in one session (film 5–8 at once). Repurpose each piece of long-form content into 3–4 derivative posts: one blog post becomes one reel, three carousel slides, five story frames, and one email newsletter item.

5. Patient Testimonial Collection & Deployment

Testimonials are the most persuasive element in your patient acquisition arsenal. A strong testimonial functions as peer validation — the closest digital equivalent to a word-of-mouth recommendation. This section covers the complete workflow: consent, collection, production, and deployment across every channel.

Consent Form Checklist

Before collecting any testimonial, ensure your practice has a compliant consent process. This checklist applies regardless of format (written, video, or audio):

- ☐ Patient is 18 years of age or older and has legal capacity to consent
- ☐ Patient has completed or is near completion of their TMS treatment course
- ☐ Patient has been informed of how the testimonial will be used (website, social media, paid ads, print)
- ☐ Patient has signed a written testimonial release form that includes: name (or anonymity preference), photo/video release, specific scope of use, right to withdraw consent, date and signature
- ☐ Patient understands they will not receive compensation for the testimonial (or if compensated, this must be disclosed)
- ☐ For video testimonials: a separate video-specific consent form is signed
- ☐ For HIPAA-covered contexts: patient has been offered the option to use a pseudonym and has agreed to the chosen format
- ☐ Consent form is filed in the patient's record
- ☐ Marketing team or external agency has received written approval to use the content

LEGAL NOTE

Consult your healthcare attorney to ensure your testimonial consent forms comply with state medical board advertising rules, FTC endorsement guidelines, and your specific malpractice insurance requirements. Regulations vary by state.

How to Ask for Testimonials

The timing and method of your ask dramatically affects response rates. The best time to request a testimonial is at the moment of peak positive emotion — typically after session 15–20 (when patients start noticing improvement) or after completing the full course of treatment.

SCRIPT: IN-PERSON ASK (BEST RESPONSE RATE)

Provider: "[Patient Name], I have to tell you — it's been really gratifying to see how well you're responding to treatment. How are you feeling compared to when you started?"

[Patient shares positive experience]

Provider: "That's wonderful to hear, and I think other people who are where you were a few weeks ago would really benefit from hearing that. Would you be open to sharing your experience? We could do a short video, or even just a written quote — whatever you're comfortable with. And we always keep it completely confidential unless you want to share your name."

SCRIPT: POST-TREATMENT EMAIL (AUTOMATED)

Subject: We'd love to hear about your TMS experience at [Clinic Name]

Hi [First Name],

Congratulations on completing your TMS treatment course at [Clinic Name]. We're so glad to have been part of your care, and we hope you're feeling the difference.

If you had a positive experience and would be willing to share a few words about your journey, your testimonial would mean a tremendous amount to us — and would help other people who are considering TMS find the courage to take the first step.

It takes less than 5 minutes. You can:

- Record a short video on your phone and email it to us, or
- Fill out our online testimonial form at [URL]

Of course, there's no obligation — and we always protect your privacy. Thank you for trusting us with your care.

Warm regards,
[Provider Name]

Video vs. Written Testimonials

VIDEO TESTIMONIALS (PREFERRED)

WRITTEN TESTIMONIALS

- **Engagement:** Video posts receive 2–3x more engagement than text on social media
- **Trust:** Facial expressions and tone of voice convey authenticity that text cannot replicate
- **Versatility:** One 60–90 second video can be repurposed into: Instagram Reel, Facebook post, YouTube short, website embed, Google Ads creative, and waiting room display
- **Production tip:** Use natural light, a ring light or softbox, and film on a smartphone in 4K. No need for professional studio — authenticity beats polish

- **Ease:** Lower barrier to entry — patients who won't film can still write
- **Specificity:** Written testimonials can be curated for exact phrases and keywords (helpful for SEO and ad copy)
- **Use cases:** Google Business Profile, Healthgrades, Yelp, website testimonial rotator, email signature, print materials
- **Formatting tip:** Include a star rating with written testimonials on review platforms. A 5-star quote is more credible than a starless one

Where to Deploy Testimonials

PLATFORM	FORMAT	BEST TYPE OF TESTIMONIAL	FREQUENCY
Google Business Profile	Written + star rating	Focus on outcome, ease of process, staff friendliness	Target 5–10 new reviews/month
Yelp / Healthgrades	Written + star rating	Clinical outcomes, wait times, billing transparency	3–5 new reviews/month per platform
Website Testimonials Page	Written + video embed	Longer-form, story-rich narratives with photos	Add new testimonial every 2 weeks
Instagram Feed / Reels	Video (60–90s)	Emotional, personal journey stories	1–2 video testimonials/month
Facebook Page / Posts	Video or written	Community-focused, relatable experiences	1 post/week
LinkedIn	Written case study + quote	Clinical outcomes, professional language	2–3 posts/month
Google Ads (Display / YouTube)	Video (15–30s)	Short, punchy, outcome-focused clips	Rotate 3–5 video creatives
Email Newsletter	Written quote + photo	Recent patient, timely and relevant	1/month in newsletter

6. ROI Tracking Spreadsheet Layout

You cannot improve what you do not measure. This section provides a complete spreadsheet framework for tracking every patient acquisition channel by its financial performance. Use this template monthly to identify your best-performing channels, cut wasted spend, and allocate budget to maximize ROI.

Key Metrics Definitions

- **CPL (Cost Per Lead):** Total channel spend ÷ number of leads generated
- **CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost):** Total marketing spend ÷ number of patients who started TMS treatment
- **ROAS (Return on Ad Spend):** Revenue generated ÷ ad spend. A ROAS of 3x means $3 in revenue for every $1 spent
- **Conversion Rate:** Percentage of leads that convert to consultations, and consultations that convert to treatment starts
- **Average Revenue Per Patient:** Include all revenue streams: TMS sessions, office visits, new patient evaluations
- **LTV (Lifetime Value):** Total revenue from a patient over their entire relationship with your practice (includes maintenance sessions, referrals they send)
- **Payback Period:** CAC ÷ monthly revenue per patient = how many months to recoup acquisition cost

Monthly ROI Tracking Template

CHANNEL	SPEND ($)	LEADS	CONSULTS	STARTS	REVENUE ($)	CPL ($)	CAC ($)	ROAS (X)	NOTES
Google Ads — Search	3,500	52	18	11	27,500	67	318	7.9	Best month ever; expanded to new zip codes
Google Ads — Display	800	31	4	2	5,000	26	400	6.3	Remarketing only; keep running
Physician Referrals	200	9	7	6	15,000	22	33	75.0	Highest ROAS channel — invest more here
Organic SEO / Blog	500	14	5	3	7,500	36	167	15.0	Content from 3 months ago starting to convert
Social Media (Organic)	0	6	2	1	2,500	0	0	∞	Building; not yet a primary lead source
Social Media (Paid Ads)	1,200	22	6	3	7,500	55	400	6.3	Instagram Reels outperforming static
Patient Referrals (WOMM)	150	5	4	3	7,500	30	50	50.0	Thank-you gift program working well
Direct / Walk-In / Other	0	8	5	4	10,000	0	0	∞	Phone calls and walk-ins
TOTALS	**6,350**	**147**	**51**	**33**	**82,500**	**43**	**192**	**13.0**	

Calculated Metrics Summary

METRIC	CALCULATION	MONTHLY RESULT	TARGET	STATUS
Blended CPL	$6,350 spend ÷ 147 leads	$43	<$80	**On Target**
Blended CAC	$6,350 spend ÷ 33 treatment starts	$192	<$350	**On Target**
Overall ROAS	$82,500 revenue ÷ $6,350 spend	13.0x	>5.0x	**Excellent**
Lead-to-Consult Rate	51 consults ÷ 147 leads	35%	>25%	**On Target**
Consult-to-Start Rate	33 starts ÷ 51 consults	65%	>50%	**On Target**
Revenue Per Patient	$82,500 ÷ 33 starts	$2,500	>$2,000	**On Target**

MONTHLY REVIEW CADENCE

Schedule a 30-minute monthly marketing review to update this spreadsheet, analyze trends, and make budget allocation decisions. Key decisions at each review: (1) Which channel has the best ROAS? Increase budget by 20–30%. (2) Which channel has the worst ROAS? Reduce budget or pause. (3) Are overall consultation numbers on track for monthly goal? Adjust total spend accordingly.

7. Glossary of Key Terms

Use this glossary as a reference for understanding the marketing and business terminology used throughout this playbook. It is also a useful patient-facing resource — share it with prospective patients who are researching TMS options online.

CAC	**Customer Acquisition Cost.** The total marketing and sales cost required to acquire one new patient. Calculated as total spend divided by number of new patients acquired in a given period. Includes advertising spend, staff time, materials, and referral program costs.
Churn	**Churn Rate.** The percentage of patients who begin TMS treatment but do not complete the full course. High churn indicates patient dropout due to cost, side effects, inconvenience, or lack of perceived benefit. Target churn rate: below 15%.
Conversion Rate	**The percentage of visitors or leads who take a desired action.** In TMS marketing, the most important conversion rates are: lead-to-consultation (how many inquiry submissions become booked appointments) and consult-to-start (how many consultations result in treatment initiation). Industry benchmark: 25–40% lead-to-consult; 50–65% consult-to-start.
CPL	**Cost Per Lead.** The amount spent to generate one patient inquiry or lead. Calculated as total channel spend divided by number of leads generated. The lower the CPL, the more efficiently the channel generates interest. Target CPL varies by market but typically ranges $40–$120 for TMS Google Ads campaigns.
CTR	**Click-Through Rate.** The percentage of people who see an ad (impressions) and click on it. Calculated as clicks ÷ impressions × 100. A higher CTR indicates more compelling ad copy or better audience targeting. Industry benchmark for TMS Google Search ads: 5–10%.
DTC	**Direct-to-Consumer.** Marketing strategies that reach and engage patients directly, bypassing physician gatekeepers. Examples include social media ads, content marketing, patient education webinars, and employer wellness programs. DTC is essential for TMS because most patients with treatment-resistant depression do not know TMS exists.
Evergreen Content	**Content that remains relevant and continues to generate traffic long after it is published.** Examples for TMS: "What is TMS therapy?", "Does insurance cover TMS?", "TMS vs. ECT." Evergreen content is the foundation of organic SEO because it accumulates search traffic over time without requiring ongoing promotion.
Funnel	**Marketing Funnel.** The journey a prospective patient takes from first awareness of your practice to booking a consultation and beginning treatment. The standard model: Awareness → Interest → Consideration → Intent → Evaluation → Booking → Treatment. Each stage requires different content and engagement strategies.
Funnel Stage	**A specific point in the patient's journey through the marketing funnel.** Top-of-funnel (TOFU) content educates and builds awareness (e.g., "What is TMS?"). Middle-of-funnel (MOFU) content addresses objections and builds consideration (e.g., "TMS vs. medication"). Bottom-of-funnel (BOFU) content drives action (e.g., "Book your free consultation").
Impression	**The number of times an ad or piece of content is displayed to a user.** Impressions are not clicks — they measure visibility. A high impression count with low click-through indicates targeting or creative issues. Impressions are used to calculate CTR (clicks ÷ impressions).
Inbound	**Inbound Marketing.** Marketing strategy that attracts patients to your practice through valuable content and experiences rather than interruptive advertising. Examples: blog articles that answer patient questions, SEO-optimized landing pages, patient education webinars. Inbound leads typically have higher conversion rates than outbound leads.
Keyword Difficulty	**A score (typically 0–100) indicating how hard it is to rank organically for a given keyword.** High difficulty keywords (60+) are dominated by established websites and require significant SEO investment. Low difficulty keywords (under 30) offer faster ranking opportunities. For local TMS practices, long-tail local keywords (e.g., "TMS therapy Austin TX") typically have lower difficulty.
LTV	**Lifetime Value.** The total revenue a patient generates for your practice over their entire relationship with you. Includes initial treatment course, maintenance sessions, additional services, and referrals they send. A patient with an LTV of $8,000 can sustain a CAC of $500 and remain profitable. Knowing your LTV is essential for setting acquisition budget.
MQL	**Marketing Qualified Lead.** A lead who has engaged with your marketing — filling out a form, downloading a guide, or calling the clinic — and meets basic criteria for being a potential patient (e.g., location, insurance, diagnosis). MQLs are passed to the sales/consultation team for follow-up.
Organic Search	**Unpaid search engine results.** When someone types a query into Google and clicks a non-ad result, that is organic traffic. Organic search is driven by SEO (Search Engine Optimization) and builds over time. A well-optimized TMS website can rank for hundreds of keywords and generate consistent, free patient inquiries indefinitely.
Paid Search	**Search engine advertising where you pay for each click on your ad.** The most common platform is Google Ads (formerly AdWords). You bid on keywords; your ad appears above or below organic results; you pay per click. Paid search provides immediate traffic and leads but stops when your budget runs out — unlike organic SEO which compounds over time.
Quality Score	**Google's rating (1–10) of the quality and relevance of your ads, keywords, and landing pages.** Higher Quality Scores lead to lower CPCs and better ad positions. Factors: expected CTR, ad relevance, and landing page experience. Target Quality Score of 7 or above for best efficiency.
Referral	**A patient directed to your practice by another healthcare provider (physician referral) or by an existing patient (patient referral).** Physician referrals are initiated by a doctor sending a patient to your TMS clinic. Patient referrals (WOMM) are initiated when existing patients recommend your practice to friends or family. Referrals convert at 3–5x the rate of cold leads.
Remarketing	**Also called Retargeting. A digital advertising technique that shows ads to people who have previously visited your website or engaged with your content.** Because these users have already shown interest, remarketing typically has 3–5x higher conversion rates than standard display advertising. Implemented via tracking pixels (e.g., Google Ads remarketing tag).
ROI	**Return on Investment.** The net profit generated from a marketing activity relative to its cost. Calculated as (Revenue − Cost) ÷ Cost. A marketing channel with an ROI of 200% generates $2 in profit for every $1 spent. ROI is the ultimate measure of marketing effectiveness.
ROAS	**Return on Ad Spend.** Specifically measures the revenue generated per dollar spent on advertising. Calculated as Revenue from Ads ÷ Ad Spend. Target ROAS varies by business model and margins — for TMS, a ROAS of 3x–5x is considered healthy; 8x+ is excellent. Note: ROAS does not account for profit margins, only revenue.
SaaS	**Software as a Service.** A software delivery model where applications are hosted in the cloud and accessed via subscription. In healthcare marketing, CRM platforms (HubSpot, Salesforce), email marketing tools (Mailchimp, Klaviyo), and scheduling software are often SaaS products. TMS List uses SaaS tools for patient acquisition analytics and CRM.

SEO	**Search Engine Optimization.** The practice of improving your website to increase its visibility in organic (non-paid) search engine results. Includes on-page SEO (keyword-optimized content, meta tags, headers), off-page SEO (backlinks, citations), and technical SEO (site speed, mobile usability, structured data). For TMS practices, local SEO (Google Business Profile optimization, local citations) is especially important.
Session	**A group of user interactions with your website that take place within a given time frame.** In Google Analytics, a single session can include multiple page views, events, and conversions. Sessions are the foundational unit of website traffic measurement. High session counts with low conversion rates indicate traffic quality issues.
UTM	**Urchin Tracking Module.** A standardized text code added to a URL to track the performance of marketing campaigns in Google Analytics. UTM parameters identify the source (e.g., google), medium (e.g., cpc), campaign (e.g., spring_tms_promo), and content (e.g., ad_variant_a). Always use UTM parameters on every link in every campaign so you can accurately attribute leads and conversions to the correct channel.
WOMM	**Word-of-Mouth Marketing.**Patient-driven referrals where existing patients recommend your practice to people in their personal network. WOMM is the most trusted form of marketing — recommendations from friends and family outperform all other advertising channels in consumer trust. Patient testimonials, referral incentive programs, and exceptional treatment experiences all fuel WOMM.

8. QR Resource Center

Use the QR codes below to connect your print materials to your digital ecosystem. Place these codes on business cards, brochures, referral pads, and patient intake packets to give referring physicians and prospective patients instant access to your TMS provider directory and pricing information.

Scan to Connect

Access TMS List resources on any device — no typing required.

tmslist.com/map/

Find a TMS provider near you

tmslist.com/pricing/

TMS cost and insurance guide

How to Use These QR Codes

- **Print brochures:** Place both codes on the back panel of your patient education brochures
- **Business cards:** Place the provider directory QR code on staff business cards for patients who want to refer friends or family
- **Referral pads:** Add the directory QR to referral pads you send to physician offices
- **Patient intake packets:** Include the pricing QR for patients concerned about cost
- **Event materials:** Add to any health fair or physician education event handout

QR CODE BEST PRACTICES

Always test QR codes by scanning them with multiple phones before printing. Use a URL shortener (e.g., bit.ly/tms-map) if the full URL is long — shorter URLs generate more reliable scans. Ensure adequate white space around the QR code (at least 0.25 inches on all sides) and avoid placing QR codes on curved or uneven surfaces. Recommended minimum print size: 0.75 inches × 0.75 inches.

Tear-Out Resource Card

TMS PATIENT ACQUISITION — QUICK-START CHECKLIST

1. Set up Google Ads campaign with 50+ TMS keywords
2. Build dedicated landing page with above-fold CTA
3. Identify 10+ top referral source physicians
4. Send initial outreach email + letter to referrers
5. Launch social media: 4 posts/week + 2 reels/week
6. Implement testimonial collection at session 15–20
7. Claim and optimize Google Business Profile
8. Publish 2 evergreen blog posts/week (SEO)
9. Set up ROI tracking spreadsheet (all channels)
10. Schedule monthly marketing performance review
11. Schedule at least 2 lunch-and-learn events/month
12. Request 3 Google/Healthgrades reviews/week

tmslist.com/map/

Get the full playbook: Scan to access the complete TMS Patient Acquisition Playbook with all templates, spreadsheets, and step-by-step guides at **tmslist.com**

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